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September 8, 2026

Recruitment Team
Frontier Economics
Cologne

Dear Recruitment Team,

I am applying for the Graduate Economic Analyst 2027 (Cologne or Berlin) position at Frontier Economics. I am completing my M.Sc. in Economics at the University of Cologne, finishing in September 2026, and I am available from October 2026.

Your competition practice works on merger control, market studies and litigation across the European Commission and the national authorities. That is where my training points. My master's thesis estimated the causal wage effect of a national scholarship programme using a heterogeneity-robust difference-in-differences design on roughly five million linked employer–employee records, and the result was a non-monotonic effect whose sign conventional two-way fixed effects estimation reverses. Merger retrospectives and damages estimation turn on the same question, which is whether the comparison you are drawing is the right one. I would like to bring that to the Cologne office, where I can also work in German with clients.

My master's thesis, graded 1.0, estimated the causal wage effects of Brazil's ProUni scholarship programme. I built the pipeline in R over roughly five million linked employer–employee records across 558 regions, applying a heterogeneity-robust difference-in-differences estimator. The result was a non-monotonic effect that conventional methods reverse in sign, which is the kind of finding that only survives careful work with large administrative data.

Before that I worked in Assurance Solutions at PwC Germany, where Excel was the daily tool for testing KPIs and preparing results for management. That taught me the discipline of getting numbers right when someone else depends on them, and how to turn a complicated dataset into a claim a reader can act on.

I work in German and English, and read French.

I would welcome the chance to discuss the role. Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,

Baha Khammari